

NURTURING HOLISTIC WELLNESS THROUGH SIDDHA

Deploying modern scientific knowledge and technology to open up Siddha's treasure for the benefit of humanity, the Central Council for Research in Siddha (CCRS) has emerged as a global leader in research and development in this unique indigenous system of medicine

Indian Systems of Medicine are among the well known global traditional systems of medicine that have played important role in meeting the healthcare needs of humanity. India has the unique distinction of having six recognised systems of medicine –Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani, Yoga & Naturopathy, Homoeopathy and Sowa-Rigpa that encompass a wide range of medical practices and therapeutic systems spanning several millennia. People are increasingly affirming their trust in traditional systems of medicine, which are gifts of India to the world, as evidenced during the Covid-19 pandemic.

The Siddha system of medicine emphasises that medical treatment is oriented not merely towards disease, but also has to take into account the patient, environment, age, habits and physical condition. Siddha, largely practised in Tamil speaking parts of India and abroad maintains a distinctive identity of its own. The term 'Siddha' comes from 'Siddhi'- which means achievement. Siddha system emphasises health as the perfect state of physical, psychological, social, and spiritual components of a human being as explained by Siddhar Thirumoolar, one of the 18 Siddhars.

Peripheral Institutes of CCRS

S.N.	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	State/UT.
1.	Siddha Central Research Institute, Chennai	Tamil Nadu
2.	Siddha Regional Research Institute, Puducherry	Puducherry
3.	Siddha Regional Research Institute, Thiruvananthapuram	Kerala
4.	Siddha Clinical Research Unit, Palayamkottai	Tamil Nadu
5.	Siddha Medicinal Plants Garden, Mettur	Tamil Nadu
6.	Siddha Clinical Research Unit, Safdarjung Hospital Campus	New Delhi
7.	Siddha Clinical Research Unit, Bengaluru	Karnataka
8.	Siddha Clinical Research Unit, Tirupati	Andhra Pradesh
9.	Siddha Clinical Research Unit, Goa	Goa

UNIQUENESS OF SIDDHA MEDICINE

- 32 types of Internal & External therapies
- Varmam manipulation methods
- Pulse Diagnosis
- Higher order medicine & Siddha Alchemy

R&D ACTIVITIES OF THE CCRS

The Union Ministry of Ayush has implemented a centrally sponsored scheme of quality control of Ayush drugs for strengthening of state pharmacies, drug testing laboratories and enforcement mechanism. The Central Council for Research in Siddha (CCRS) is an autonomous body under the Ministry of Ayush. It is an apex body for initiating, undertaking, formulating, developing, coordinating, and promoting research in Siddha on scientific lines.

CCRS has emerged as a global leader in research in the Siddha system of medicine. The research programmes of CCRS focus on clinical research including safety and efficacy studies of Siddha drugs, validation of the fundamental principles, drug standardisation, quality control, survey and cultivation of medicinal plants, and literary research. The propagation of this system through Information, Education, and Communication (IEC), extension of health services including Swasthya Raksha Programme (SRP), OPD and IPD services also form part of the Council's activities.

SUCCESS STORIES

The trial on psoriasis conducted at SCRI, Chennai led to an effective remedy for this chronic disease. The drug was patented through National Research Development Corporation.

A clinical trial on breast cancer with coded Siddha formulations was conducted and the study outcome showed a reduction in pain, growth, and size of malignant ulcers. There was also a reduction in foul-smelling discharge and bleeding in cases of cervical cancer.

Post clinical trials, D5 Chooranam (Siddha coded polyherbal formulation) for Diabetes Mellitus has been introduced in the OPDs of peripheral institutes/units of CCRS.

Siddha medicine has proven to be useful in mitigating the epidemic outbreaks of viral fevers like chikungunya, dengue, and bird flu, where the efficacy of Siddha has been evaluated in research laboratories as well as clinical centres, leading to the administration of these Siddha drugs along with allopathic drugs in all the government hospitals.

CCRS with the support of premier medical institutes in the country has carried out several clinical trials including double-blind randomised placebo-controlled trials in generating evidence of Siddha formulations in mitigating Covid-19.

A module for Varmam (pressure manipulation therapy) has been developed by CCRS and provided to government of Malaysia. Siddha Medical services were extended even at Sungoi Buloh Government Hospital in Malaysia sponsored by the Government of India.

Siddha Medicinal Plants Garden (SMPG) at Mettur Dam, Salem in Tamil Nadu is an exclusive wing of the CCRS to promote, propagate, conserve, and cultivate medicinal plants along with medico ethno botanical study on medicinal plants of Tamil Nadu.

Headed by Prof Dr R Meenakumari, Director General (Additional Charge), CCRS has helped India attain global leadership in treatment and prevention of lifestyle-related diseases. It has been employing modern scientific knowledge and technology to open up Siddha's treasure for the benefit of humanity.

For more details visit siddhacouncil.com